

Essay Tools Feedback Briefing

We are exploring a focused set of essay-support tools for admissions consultants. The goal is not to replace expert judgment, but to make consultant work better-evidenced, more consistent, and easier to document.

What we need from consultants: practical judgment about usefulness, risks, workflow fit, and implementation priorities.

Tools under consideration

- **Past essay topic distribution with outcome context:** Summaries of topics and themes from prior applications, with careful outcome context only where data is validated.
- **Essay topic recommender:** Brainstorming support based on a student's activities, background, and prompt.
- **Essay scorer:** Structured feedback on clarity, specificity, voice, distinctiveness, and prompt alignment.
- **Essay ranker / comparison tool:** Comparison across drafts or against anonymized patterns from past essays.
- **School recommender from Common App statement:** Possible school-fit signals based on themes and strengths in the main essay.

Design principles

- **Consultant augmentation, not replacement.** The system should sharpen professional judgment, not automate it.
- **Evidence with humility.** Historical examples can be useful, but should not be overinterpreted as guarantees.
- **Guardrails matter.** Any tool that encourages generic essays, inflated scoring, or false certainty should be redesigned or rejected.
- **Workflow fit matters.** We are interested in where these tools would actually help: topic selection, drafting, revision, school strategy, or final review.

What your feedback will influence

Your response will help prioritize which tools deserve prototype development, which should be deferred, and what safeguards should be required before any consultant-facing release.